

Special Points Decoder

The 15 Collaterals — Luo-Connecting Points, in Full

Standalone reference — pairs with the Week 8 Study Guide

This Decoder Covers:

- All 15 Luo-Connecting Points, in full — the star special-point category this week
- The “why 15, not 12” structural logic, and the front/back/side coverage principle
- Special-point identity overlaps — points that are BOTH a Luo point AND a Confluent point
- A/B/C tiered cumulative recap of every other special-point category (Yuan-Source through Crossing Points), rolled forward from the Week 6 pilot

The Luo-Connecting point IS the special-point content for this week -- no new organ-based categories (Yuan-Source, He-Sea, etc.) are introduced. GB/LR Luo points are self-study slide content, flagged accordingly below.

The 15 Luo-Connecting Points (Luo Mai)

This week's star category

The 12 Primary Meridians and the Conception and Governor Vessels each give off a collateral branch, totaling fifteen when combined with the Major (Great) Collateral of the Spleen -- collectively the “15 Collaterals” (Luo Mai). Each is named after the acupoint from which it originates -- its Luo-Connecting point.

Function: the Luo-Connecting point's job is to link (n, Luo = “net/connect”) each meridian to its interior-exteriorly paired partner, strengthening their shared function and treating disorders that involve both. Distinguish from a Yuan-Source point (treats disorders of its OWN meridian) and from a Confluent point (opens an Extraordinary Vessel). One acupoint can carry more than one of these special-point identities at once (e.g. LU 7 is both Luo point AND CV's Confluent point) -- when a point carries multiple special functions, its clinical reach is broader/stronger.

MERIDIAN	LUO POINT	CONNECTS TO
Lung (LU)	LU 7 Lieque	Large Intestine
Large Intestine (LI)	LI 6 Pianli	Lung
Stomach (ST)	ST 40 Fenglong	Spleen
Spleen (SP)	SP 4 Gongsun	Stomach
Heart (HT)	HT 5 Tongli	Small Intestine
Small Intestine (SI)	SI 7 Zhizheng	Heart
Bladder (BL)	BL 58 Feiyang	Kidney
Kidney (KI)	KI 4 Dazhong	Bladder
Pericardium (PC)	PC 6 Neiguan	Sanjiao (Triple Energizer)
Sanjiao (SJ)	SJ 5 Waiguan	Pericardium
Gallbladder (GB)	GB 37 Guangming	Liver [self-study]
Liver (LR)	LR 5 Ligou	Gallbladder [self-study]
Collateral of the Conception Vessel (Ren Mai)		CV 15 Jiuwei
Collateral of the Governor Vessel (Du Mai)		GV 1 Changqiang
Great (Major) Collateral of the Spleen		SP 21 Dabao

[self-study] = GB/LR collaterals were slide-deck content Dr. Zhang did not reach live.

General Luo-point definition (Special Points lecture): “From the point where each of the fifteen Collaterals diverges from the main channels, there is one shu-acupoint.” Location pattern: the Luo points of the 12 paired meridians sit below the elbow or knee joints; the Luo point of the CV (Jiuwei, CV 15) sits in the upper abdomen; the Luo point of the GV (Changqiang, GV 1) sits in the sacrococcygeal region; the Great Luo of the Spleen (Dabao, SP 21) sits in the chest/hypochondriac region. Function: treats deficiency and excess patterns; communicates and connects the exterior and interior meridians; the Luo points of CV, GV, and the Great Luo of the Spleen specifically treat ANTERIOR and POSTERIOR lesions of the trunk (front/back/side coverage, per the “why 15” logic).

Flagged, not silently corrected: the “General Nomenclature of TCM 15 Collaterals” summary table in the 2026 slide deck (2026AC300Lecture_8Vivian.pdf, and also 2026AC300Lecture_9Vivian.pdf) has a row-swap error in its first two rows -- it pairs “Pericardium Meridian of Hand Taiyin” with “Lie Que LU7” and “Lung Meridian of Hand Jueyin” with “Neiguan PC6.” This is backwards: Lieque LU7 belongs to the Lung (Hand-Taiyin), and Neiguan PC6 belongs to the Pericardium (Hand-Jueyin), as correctly shown elsewhere in this SAME deck's own point-by-point collateral slides, and as correctly shown in the original prior-year deck (Lecture8vivian1119.pdf). All tables and figures in these materials use the correct pairing (LU7=Lung, PC6=Pericardium).

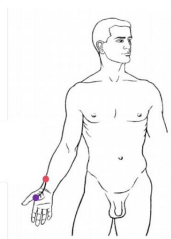
Luo Point Pathway Diagrams -- Outer & Inner Circuit

The Collateral of Outer Circuit(1)

➤ The Collateral of the Lung Meridian of Hand-Taiyin

It arises from **Lieque (LU 7)** and runs to the Large Intestine Meridian of Hand Yangming.

Another branch follows the Lung Meridian of Hand Taiyin into the palm of the hand and spreads through the thenar eminence.



Lung

19

Lung (LU)
LU 7 Lieque

The Collateral of Outer Circuit(2)

➤ The Collateral of the Large Intestine Meridian of Hand-Yangming

It starts from **Pianli (LI 6)** and joins the Lung Meridian of Hand-Taiyin three cun above the wrist.

Another branch runs along the arm to Jianyu (LI 15), crosses the jaw and extends to the teeth. Still another branch derives at the jaw and enters the ear to join the Thoroughfare Vessel.



Large Intestine

20

Large Intestine (LI)
LI 6 Pianli

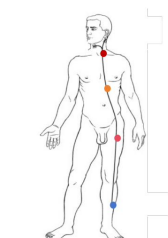
The Collateral of Outer Circuit(3)

➤ The Collateral of the Stomach Meridian of Foot-Yangming

It starts from **Fenglong (ST 40)**, eight cun above the external malleolus, it connects with the Spleen Meridian.

A branch runs along the lateral aspect of the tibia upward to the top of the head and converges with the other Yang Meridians on the head and neck.

From there it runs downward to connect with the throat.



Stomach

29

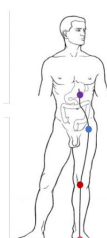
Stomach (ST)
ST 40 Fenglong

The Collateral of Outer Circuit(4)

➤ The Collateral of the Spleen Meridian of Foot-Taiyin

It branches out at **Gongsun (SP 4)**, one cun posterior to the base of the first metatarsal bone and then joins the Stomach Meridian.

A branch runs upward to the abdomen and connects with the stomach and intestines.



Spleen

30

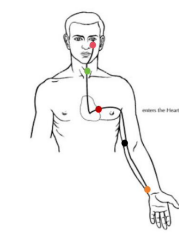
Spleen (SP)
SP 4 Gongsun

The Collateral of inner Circuit(1)

➤ The Collateral of the Heart Meridian of Hand-Shaoyin

It branches out at **Tongli (HT 5)**. One cun above the transverse crease of the wrist, it connects with the Small Intestine Meridian of Hand Taiyang.

About one and a half cun above the wrist, it again follows the meridian and enters the heart; it then runs to the root of the tongue and connects with the eye.



Heart

39

Heart (HT)
HT 5 Tongli

The Collateral of inner Circuit(2)

➤ The Collateral of the Small Intestine Meridian of Hand-Taiyang

It originates from **Zhizheng (SI 7)**. Five cun above the wrist, it connects with the Heart Meridian.

Another branch runs upward, crosses the elbow and connects with Jianyu (LI 15).



Small Intestine

40

Small Intestine (SI)
SI 7 Zhizheng

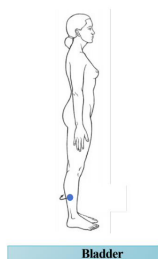
Lecture Fig. -- Lecture8vivan1119.pdf, slides 19-20 (LU/LI), 29-30 (ST/SP), 39-40 (HT/SI). Dr. Zhang.

Luo Point Pathway Diagrams -- Inner & Middle Circuit

The Collateral of inner Circuit(3)

➤ The Collateral of the Bladder Meridian of Foot-Taiyang

It arises from **Feiyang (BL 58)**, seven cun above the external malleolus, it connects with the Kidney Meridian.



Bladder

47

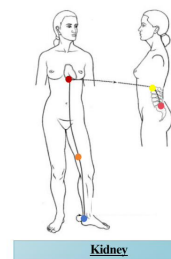
Bladder (BL)
BL 58 Feiyang

The Collateral of inner Circuit(4)

➤ The Collateral of the Kidney Meridian of Foot-Shaoyin

It originates from **Dazhong (KI 4)** on the posterior aspect of internal malleolus; it crosses the heel and joins the Bladder Meridian.

A branch follows the Kidney Meridian upward to a point below the pericardium and then pierces through the lumbar vertebrae.



Kidney

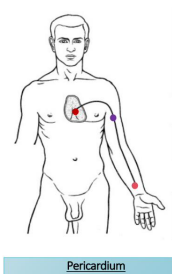
48

Kidney (KI)
KI 4 Dazhong

The Collateral of Middle Circuit(1)

➤ The Collateral of the Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin

It begins from **Neiguan (PC 6)**, two cun above the wrist, disperses between the two tendons and runs along the Pericardium Meridian to the Pericardium, and finally connects with the heart.



Pericardium

58

Pericardium (PC)
PC 6 Neiguan

The Collateral of Middle Circuit(2)

➤ The Collateral of the Triple Energizer Meridian of Hand-Shaoyang

It arises from **Waiguan (TE 5)**, two cun above the dorsum of the wrist, it travels up the posterior aspect of the arm and over the shoulder, disperses in the chest, converging with the Pericardium Meridian.



SanJiao

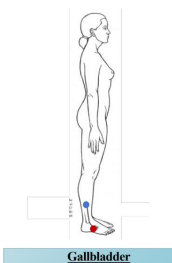
59

Sanjiao (SJ)
SJ 5 Waiguan

The Collateral of Middle Circuit(3)

➤ The Collateral of the Gallbladder Meridian of Foot-Shaoyang

It begins from **Guangming (GB 37)**, five cun above the external malleolus, it joins the Liver Meridian and then runs downward and disperses over the dorsum of the foot.



Gallbladder

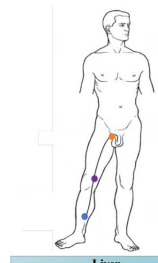
66

Gallbladder (GB)
GB 37 Guangming

The Collateral of Middle Circuit(4)

➤ The Collateral of the Liver Meridian of Foot Jueyin

It starts from **Ligou (LR 5)**, five cun above the internal malleolus and connects with the Gallbladder Meridian. A branch runs up the leg to the genitals.



Liver

67

Liver (LR)
LR 5 Ligou

Lecture Fig. -- Lecture8viviann1119.pdf, slides 47-48 (BL/KI), 58-59 (PC/SJ), 66-67 (GB/LR, self-study). Dr. Zhang.

Why 15, Not 12? -- The Structural Logic

Why 15, not 12? The 12 paired meridians (6 yin-yang pairs) each need a Luo-Connecting point to link them -- that's 12. But the 12 primary meridians don't have their own acupoints EVERYWHERE harmony is needed: two extra vessels (Du Mai/GV and Ren Mai/CV) have their own dedicated points, so they each need their own collateral too -- that's 14. And there is one region no collateral yet covers: the LATERAL side of the chest (CV covers front, GV covers back, but nothing covers the side). The Spleen's Great Collateral (Dabao, SP 21) fills that gap -- bringing the total to 15.

Full course detail for each of the 3 “extra” collaterals:

Collateral of the Conception Vessel (Ren Mai) -- CV 15 Jiuwei

Separates from the Governor Vessel at the lower end of the sternum; from Jiuwei (CV 15) it spreads over the abdomen.

Why it exists: Covers the FRONT midline -- balances the GV collateral on the back midline.

Collateral of the Governor Vessel (Du Mai) -- GV 1 Changqiang

Arises from Changqiang (GV 1) in the perineum; runs upward along both sides of the spine to the nape and spreads over the top of the head. At the scapular region it connects with the Bladder meridian and pierces through the spine.

Why it exists: Covers the BACK midline -- balances the CV collateral on the front midline.

Great (Major) Collateral of the Spleen -- SP 21 Dabao

Begins from Dabao (SP 21), emerges 3 cun below Yuanye (GB 22), and spreads through the chest and hypochondriac (lateral costal) region, gathering the blood all over the body.

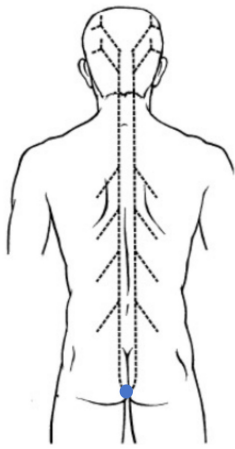
Why it exists: Covers the LATERAL side of the chest -- the one area the 12 paired-meridian collaterals leave uncovered. This is WHY there are 15 collaterals, not 12: the body needs front (CV), back (GV), AND lateral (Spleen Great Luo) coverage to stay in harmony.

MEMORY AID

The 12 paired-meridian Luo points all sit on the LIMBS (wrist for Hand meridians, ankle for Foot meridians). The 3 extra Luo points are the exception -- all three sit on the TRUNK (sternum, perineum, lateral chest), because their entire purpose is to cover trunk surface area no limb-based point could reach.

The 3 Extra Collaterals -- Lecture Diagram

Additional (Luo) Channels



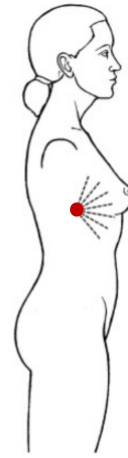
GV (Du) Mai

Begins at **Du1** and moves superiorly on both sides of spine to the neck and spreads over the posterior side of the head, connects with BL channel in the scapula region and passes through the spine



CV (Ren) Mai

From **Ren15**, descends and spreads over the abdomen



Great Luo of Spleen

Separates from primary channel at **SP21** and spreads throughout the chest and lateral costal region

74

Lecture Fig. -- 2026AC300Lecture_8Vivian.pdf, "Additional (Luo) Channels" slide. Dr. Zhang. Not present as a diagram in the older Lecture8vivian1119.pdf deck (text-only there) -- sourced from the current-year deck.

Clinical Indications -- The 12 Paired Luo Points

Precise location + treats

Course and distribution (CAM textbook, cited in lecture): the twelve collateral channels branch out from the Luo-Connecting points of their respective meridians and travel toward their interior-exteriorly related paired meridians. The collateral channels of the Ren (CV), Du (GV), and Spleen meridians branch out from their own Luo-Connecting points, spreading across the abdomen, back of the head, and chest-rib regions respectively.

LU 7 Lieque (Lung)

Location: Superior to the styloid process of the radius, 1.5 cun above the transverse wrist crease, between brachioradialis and the tendon of abductor pollicis longus.

Indications: Headache, migraine, neck rigidity, cough, asthma, sore throat, facial paralysis, toothache, pain and weakness of the wrist.

LI 6 Pianli (Large Intestine)

Location: With the elbow flexed, radial side of the arm upward: on the line joining Yangxi (LI 5) and Quchi (LI 11), 3 cun above the wrist crease.

Indications: Redness of the eye, tinnitus, deafness, epistaxis, aching of the hand and arm, sore throat, edema.

ST 40 Fenglong (Stomach)

Location: 8 cun superior to the tip of the external malleolus, lateral to Tiaokou (ST 38), about two fingerbreadths lateral to the anterior border of the tibia.

Indications: Headache, dizziness and vertigo, cough, asthma, excessive sputum, chest pain, constipation, mania, epilepsy, muscular atrophy, motor impairment, pain, swelling or paralysis of the lower extremities.

SP 4 Gongsun (Spleen)

Location: In the depression distal and inferior to the base of the 1st metatarsal bone, at the junction of the red and white skin.

Indications: Gastric pain, vomiting, abdominal pain and distension, diarrhea, dysentery, borborygmus.

HT 5 Tongli (Heart)

Location: Palm facing upward: on the radial side of the flexor carpi ulnaris tendon, 1 cun above the transverse wrist crease.

Indications: Palpitation, dizziness, blurring of vision, sore throat, sudden loss of voice, aphasia with stiffness of the tongue, pain in the wrist and elbow.

SI 7 Zhizheng (Small Intestine)

Location: On the line joining Yanggu (SI 5) and Xiaohai (SI 8), 5 cun proximal to the dorsal wrist crease.

Indications: Neck rigidity, headache, dizziness, spasmodic pain in the elbow and fingers, febrile diseases, mania.

BL 58 Feiyang (Bladder)

Location: 7 cun directly above Kunlun (BL 60), on the posterior border of the fibula, about 1 cun lateral and inferior to Chengshan (BL 57).

Indications: Headache, blurring of vision, nasal obstruction, epistaxis, back pain, hemorrhoids, weakness of the leg.

KI 4 Dazhong (Kidney)

Location: Posterior and inferior to the medial malleolus, in the depression anterior to the medial side of the Achilles tendon attachment.

Indications: Spitting of blood, asthma, stiffness and pain of the lower back, dysuria, constipation, pain in the heel, dementia.

PC 6 Neiguan (Pericardium)

Location: 2 cun above the transverse wrist crease, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis.

Indications: Cardiac pain, palpitation, stuffy chest, pain in the hypochondriac region, stomachache, nausea, vomiting, hiccup, mental disorders, epilepsy, insomnia, febrile diseases, irritability, malaria, contracture and pain of the elbow and arm.

Clinical Indications -- The 12 Paired Luo Points (cont.)

SJ 5 Waiguan (Sanjiao)

Location: 2 cun proximal to the dorsal wrist crease, on the line connecting Yangchi (SJ 4) and the tip of the olecranon, between the radius and ulna.

Indications: Febrile diseases, headache, cheek pain, strained neck, deafness, tinnitus, hypochondriac pain, motor impairment of the elbow and arm, finger pain, hand tremor.

GB 37 Guangming (Gallbladder) [self-study]

Location: 5 cun directly above the tip of the external malleolus, on the anterior border of the fibula.

Indications: Knee pain, muscular atrophy, motor impairment and pain of the lower extremities, blurring of vision, ophthalmalgia, night blindness, distending pain of the breast.

LR 5 Ligou (Liver) [self-study]

Location: 5 cun above the tip of the medial malleolus, on the midline of the medial surface of the tibia.

Indications: Retention of urine, enuresis, hernia, irregular menstruation, leukorrhea, pruritus vulvae, weakness and atrophy of the leg.

Special-Point Identity Overlaps

Points that carry more than one function

Some acupoints carry more than one special-point identity at once. Below: every Luo-Connecting point that ALSO serves as the Confluent (opening) point of an Extraordinary Vessel -- all four were reviewed in Week 7 and recur here as the clearest examples of this principle. A point with multiple special-point identities has a broader, stronger clinical reach than a single-purpose point.

LU 7 Lieque

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Lung

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Ren Mai (CV)

Cough, sore throat, chest tightness (Luo function) + regulates all yin meridians via Ren Mai (Confluent function).

SP 4 Gongsun

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Spleen

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Chong Mai

Digestive/abdominal disorders (Luo function) + Sea-of-Blood/12-meridian regulation via Chong Mai (Confluent function).

PC 6 Neiguan

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Pericardium

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Yin Wei Mai

Chest/heart symptoms (Luo function) + dominates the interior, links all yin meridians via Yin Wei Mai (Confluent function).

SJ 5 Waiguan

As Luo point: Luo-Connecting point of Sanjiao

Also: Confluent (opening) point of Yang Wei Mai

Exterior/febrile symptoms (Luo function) + dominates the exterior, links all yang meridians via Yang Wei Mai (Confluent function).

Cumulative Recap — All Other Special-Point Categories Tiered A/B/C, per the Week 6 pilot

No organ-based special-point categories are newly introduced this week (Week 8's own content is the Luo-Connecting points above). The categories below stay exactly as covered previously -- listed here for cumulative review, with the A/B/C exam-priority tiering piloted in the Week 6 Decoder, rolled forward as planned.

Tier key: A = high-yield, drill to automaticity. B = know the definition + 1 example cold. C = recognize the name and general function only.

A	YUAN-SOURCE Where the Source (Yuan) Qi is accessed. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (PC7, SJ4, GB40, LR3)</i>
A	LUO-CONNECTING Where a Luo-vessel branches to the paired channel. <i>THIS WEEK -- see full treatment above.</i>
A	HE-SEA At elbow/knee; treats counterflow Qi and organ-level disorders. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (PC3, SJ10, GB34, LR8)</i>
B	XI-CLEFT Cleft point for acute conditions/pain. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (PC4, SJ7, GB36, LR6)</i>
B	FRONT-MU Where a zang/fu organ's Qi gathers anteriorly. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (CV17, CV5, GB24, LR14)</i>
B	BACK-SHU Bladder-channel transport points for each organ. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (BL14, BL22, BL19, BL18)</i>
B	CONFLUENT (OPENING) POINTS Access point for each Extraordinary Vessel. <i>Full treatment: Week 7 Decoder (all 4 master-couple pairs)</i>
C	HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL) 8 points, meeting place for a tissue/substance category. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (GB34 = Sinews; LR13 = Zang)</i>
C	JING-WELL / YING-SPRING / SHU-STREAM / JING-RIVER The Five-Shu points along each channel. <i>Last new examples: Week 6</i>
C	LOWER HE-SEA Special He-Sea points for the 6 Fu organs, on the leg. <i>Last new examples: Week 6 (SJ's is BL39, off-channel)</i>
C	COALESCENT POINTS (JIAO HUI XUE) Meeting points between an Extraordinary Vessel and a primary meridian. <i>Full treatment: Week 7 Decoder</i>
C	CROSSING POINTS A point crossed by more than one channel's pathway. <i>GB count still flagged/unresolved (Week 6)</i>